



Directorate of Extension
Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agricultural Sciences and Technology of Kashmir



KRISHI VIGYAN KENDRA (KVK) GUREZ



Medicinal & Aromatic Plant (MAPs) Resources of Gurez Valley:

AN INSTRUMENT TOWARDS
TRADITIONAL HEALING PRACTICES

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57	<i>Viscum odorata</i> Linn. Local Name: Banada Family: Viscaceae Habit: Shrub Altitudinal range (amsl): 1800-3500 m Traditional use: A warm paste prepared from the plant is applied externally to relieve rheumatism, joint pain, and muscular inflammation. The species continues to be used in traditional folk medicine across the valley.	
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Way Forward

The rich medicinal and aromatic plant diversity of Gurez Valley represents an invaluable ecological, cultural, and economic resource that warrants urgent conservation and sustainable utilization. Future efforts will focus on strengthening in situ and ex situ conservation of threatened species, expanding the MAPs Germplasm Bank, and promoting scientific cultivation of high-value medicinal plants to reduce pressure on wild populations. Systematic documentation and validation of indigenous traditional knowledge, coupled with awareness programmes and capacity building for farmers and rural youth, will help preserve this unique heritage while creating sustainable livelihood opportunities. Collaborative research involving local communities, research institutions, government agencies, and conservation organizations will be encouraged to develop evidence-based conservation strategies, value-addition technologies, and market linkages. Through an integrated approach that combines traditional wisdom with modern science, Gurez Valley can emerge as a model landscape for biodiversity conservation, herbal healthcare, and sustainable rural development in the Himalayan region.

MAPs of Gurez: A Bird’s Eye view

Gurez Valley, situated in the high-altitude landscapes of the Kashmir Himalaya, is renowned for its pristine environment, rich biodiversity, and unique cultural heritage. The valley encompasses a wide range of habitats, including alpine meadows, sub-alpine pastures, riverine ecosystems, and temperate forests, which collectively support a diverse assemblage of medicinal and aromatic plants. For generations, the inhabitants of Gurez have depended upon these natural resources to meet their healthcare needs, developing a rich repository of traditional knowledge on the therapeutic uses of local flora.

Medicinal plants form an integral part of the traditional healthcare system of the valley. Local communities possess extensive knowledge regarding the identification, collection, preparation, and application of herbal remedies for the treatment of various ailments. These remedies are commonly used to manage respiratory disorders, digestive complaints, liver diseases, fever, wounds, rheumatism, urinary problems, skin infections, and reproductive health issues. Such indigenous knowledge, accumulated through centuries of observation and experience, represents an invaluable cultural and biological heritage.

The valley is home to several high-value medicinal plant species. These species are highly prized in traditional systems of medicine and contribute significantly to rural livelihoods through their medicinal and economic value. However, increasing anthropogenic pressure, unsustainable harvesting practices, habitat degradation, and changing climatic conditions pose serious threats to many of these valuable species. Conservation of medicinal plant diversity, promotion of sustainable harvesting practices, and preservation of traditional knowledge have therefore become critical for safeguarding these resources for future generations.

This booklet presents a compilation of important medicinal plants recorded from Gurez Valley, highlighting their local names, traditional uses, and significance in indigenous healthcare systems. It seeks to document and celebrate the ethnobotanical heritage of the region while promoting awareness about the conservation and sustainable utilization of medicinal plant resources. By bridging traditional wisdom with scientific understanding, this publication aims to contribute towards biodiversity conservation, community well-being, and the sustainable development of the Himalayan region.

KVK Gurez Interventions for Promotion of MAPs in Gurez Valley

Gurez Valley harbours a rich diversity of medicinal and aromatic plants with immense ecological, medicinal, and economic value. However, many of these high-value species are under severe threat due to indiscriminate and unsustainable harvesting from wild populations, habitat degradation, limited awareness regarding conservation, and the lack of systematic documentation of traditional ethnomedicinal knowledge. Despite their high market demand and significant potential to enhance rural livelihoods through cultivation, value addition, and entrepreneurship, these resources remain largely underutilized. Recognizing these challenges and opportunities, KVK Gurez has initiated focused interventions to document traditional knowledge, conserve threatened germplasm, promote scientific cultivation, and build the

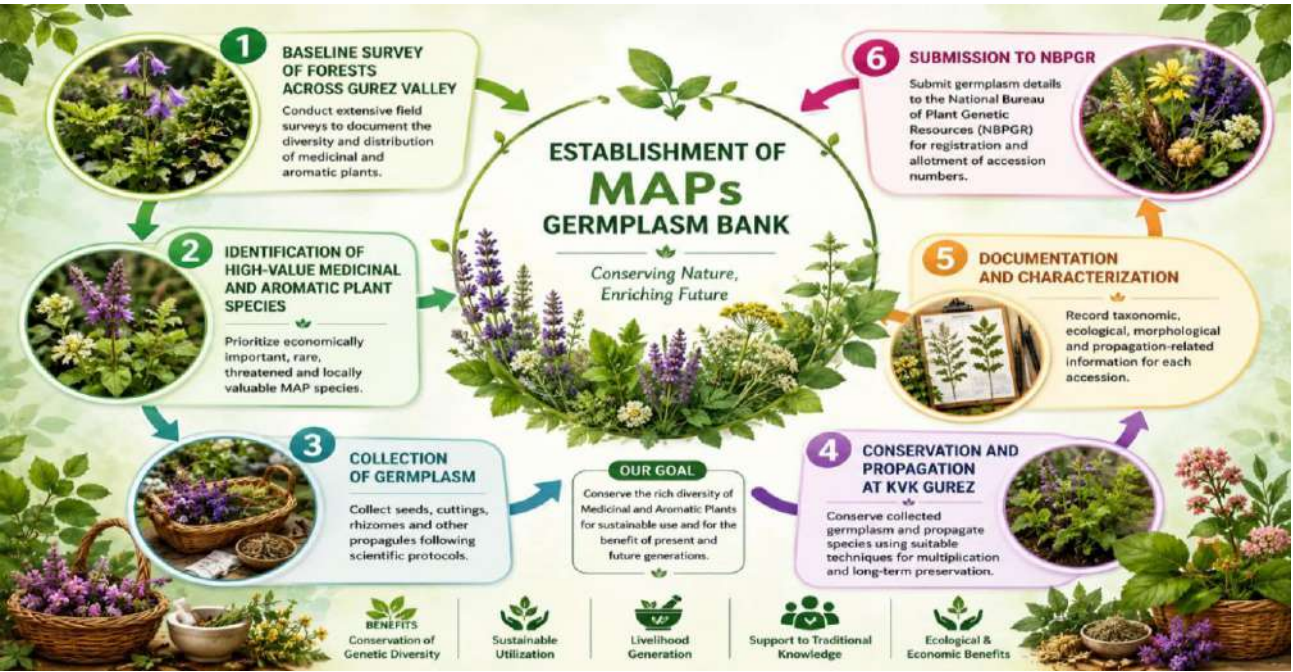
capacity of local communities, thereby ensuring biodiversity conservation while unlocking the economic potential of medicinal and aromatic plants for sustainable livelihood development.

Documentation of Traditional Knowledge

Recognizing the immense medicinal, ecological, and economic significance of Medicinal and Aromatic Plants (MAPs), KVK Gurez has initiated systematic field surveys across different habitats of Gurez Valley to document the region's rich medicinal plant wealth. The initiative focuses on identifying and recording indigenous medicinal plant species, their traditional uses, distribution patterns, population status, and conservation needs. Special emphasis is being placed on high-value Himalayan medicinal plants that form an integral part of the traditional healthcare system and livelihood security of local communities. As part of this effort, KVK Gurez is documenting traditional knowledge associated with medicinal plants through interactions with local elders, traditional healers, shepherds, and farming communities. Simultaneously, studies on population ecology are being undertaken to assess species abundance, habitat preferences, regeneration status, and threats affecting natural populations. These surveys are generating valuable baseline information for the conservation and sustainable management of medicinal plant resources in the valley.

Establishment of MAPs Germplasm Bank

To conserve the rich medicinal plant diversity of Gurez Valley, KVK Gurez has established a Medicinal and Aromatic Plants (MAPs) Germplasm Bank for the collection, conservation, and propagation of important medicinal species. The germplasm bank serves as a repository of high-value and threatened Himalayan medicinal plants, ensuring the preservation of their genetic resources for future generations. It also provides quality planting material, supports research and demonstration activities, and promotes the cultivation of medicinal plants among farmers and rural youth as a sustainable livelihood option while reducing pressure on wild populations.



Workflow for Conservation of High-Value Medicinal and Aromatic Plants

53	<i>Thymus linearis</i> Linn. Local Name: Javen Family: Lamiaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000-4000 m Traditional use: The whole herb is used as a decoction to treat flatulence, indigestion, and menstrual disorders. Its aromatic nature also makes it a popular herbal remedy.	
54	<i>Trifolium pratense</i> Linn. Local Name: Lalchopati Family: Fabaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 1800-3500 m Traditional use: The dried herb is consumed as a herbal tea and used as an expectorant in respiratory ailments such as cough and congestion.	
55	<i>Valeriana hardwickii</i> Wall. Local Name: Mushk Bala Family: Valerianaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000-4000 m Traditional use: The powdered roots are traditionally inhaled to treat hysteria, epilepsy, and nervous disorders. The species is well known for its calming and sedative properties.	
56	<i>Viola sylvatica</i> Fries Local Name: Banafsha Family: Violaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 1800-3500 m Traditional use: The dried plant is boiled to prepare a medicinal tea used for treating cough, cold, and throat ailments. It remains one of the most commonly used herbal remedies in the region.	

49	<i>Rheum australe</i> D. Don Local Name: Pambchalan Family: Polygonaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2800-4500 m Traditional use: The roots possess purgative properties and are used in the treatment of constipation, stomach disorders, and liver ailments. The species is highly valued in traditional medicine.	
50	<i>Saussurea costus</i> (Falc.) Lipsch Local Name: Kuth Family: Asteraceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2500-4000 m Traditional use: The root paste is applied externally to relieve rheumatism, joint pain, and muscular inflammation. Historically, this species was one of the most valuable medicinal plants traded from Kashmir.	
51	<i>Taraxacum officinale</i> Weber ex Wiggers Local Name: Hand Family: Asteraceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 1800-4000 m Traditional use: A decoction of the roots is used as a hepatic stimulant and is especially valued in the treatment of jaundice. The cooked leaves are traditionally given to pregnant women at the time of delivery to facilitate smooth childbirth.	
52	<i>Taxus baccata</i> Linn. Local Name: Postul Family: Taxaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000-3500 m Traditional use: The bark is prepared as a decoction or herbal tea and used for the treatment of asthma, bronchitis, and respiratory ailments. The species is also recognized globally for its medicinal significance.	



Species Collection



Bed Preparation and Transplanting of Species

Knowledge based, Skill oriented ssCapacity Building Programmes

To promote livelihood diversification and entrepreneurship, KVK Gurez is also conducting continuous awareness and capacity-building programmes for farmers and educated youth interested in the cultivation, processing, and value addition of medicinal and aromatic plants. Through training programmes, field demonstrations, exposure visits, and technical guidance, local stakeholders are being encouraged to adopt MAP cultivation as a sustainable income-generating enterprise. These efforts aim to reduce pressure on wild populations while creating new opportunities for employment, rural development, and biodiversity conservation in the remote Himalayan landscapes of Gurez Valley.

Major Capacity Building Programmes Conducted on Medicinal and Aromatic Plants by KVK Gurez

S. No.	Name of Training Programme	Funding/Sponsoring Agency	Duration	No. of Programmes
1	Management of Cultivation, Processing and Marketing for Entrepreneurship Development in Medicinal Plants of Gurez Valley (EMDP)	MSME, Government of India	1 Week	1
2	Promoting Cultivation, Conservation and Entrepreneurship of Medicinal Plants in Gurez Valley	MSME, Government of India	1 Day	1
3	Potential and Prospects of Medicinal Plants in Gurez Valley	RCFC, NR-II	1 Day	2
4	Cultivation and Processing of Medicinal and Aromatic Plants	Division of Forest Products & Utilization, Faculty of Forestry, SKUAST-K (AICRP on MAPs)	1 Day	1
5	Awareness Programme on Medicinal Plants for Livelihood Generation in Gurez Valley	KVK Gurez	1 Day	04

45	<i>Polygonum viviparum</i> Linn. Local Name: Churkee Family: Polygonaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2500-4500 m Traditional use: The roots are used to treat diarrhoea and dysentery. A paste of the roots is also applied externally to stop bleeding and promote healing of ulcers.	
46	<i>Rubia cordifolia</i> Linn. Local Name: Manjithi Family: Rubiaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 1500-3500 m Traditional use: The roots are traditionally used for the treatment of stomach ache and digestive disorders. The plant is also valued for its medicinal and dye-producing properties.	
47	<i>Rosa webbiana</i> Wall. ex Royle Local name: Gulab Family: Rosaceae Habit: Shrub Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000-4000 m Traditional use: The fruits (rose hips) are rich in vitamin C and are traditionally used to prepare syrups and remedies for cold, cough, and general weakness.	
48	<i>Rheum webbianum</i> Royle Local Name: Pambchalan Family: Polygonaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 3000-4500 m Traditional use: The roots are used as a laxative and stomachic. Traditional healers also prescribe preparations of the plant for digestive disorders and liver complaints. It is among the important medicinal rhubarbs of the western Himalaya.	

41	<i>Picrorhiza kurroa</i> Royle ex Benth. Local Name: Kutki Family: Scrophulariaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 3000-4500 m Traditional use: The powdered roots are extensively used in indigenous medicine for liver disorders, particularly jaundice. This species is one of the most valued medicinal plants of the Himalayan region.	
42	<i>Pimpinella diversifolia</i> DC. Local Name: Hyo-kachh Family: Apiaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000–3500 m Traditional use: A hot aqueous extract of the plant is taken as a carminative to improve digestion and relieve gastric discomfort.	
43	<i>Plantago lanceolata</i> Linn. Local Name: Phatal Kachh Family: Plantaginaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 1500–3500 m Traditional use: The seeds are consumed with milk as a purgative and are traditionally used to regulate bowel movements.	
44	<i>Podophyllum hexandrum</i> Royle Local Name: Chhamadeh/Wanwagun Family: Berberidaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2500-4200 m Traditional use: The powdered roots are used in the treatment of hepatic enlargement and other liver-related disorders. It is an important high-value medicinal species of the Himalayas.	



7 Days MSME Training Programme



One Day MSME Training Programme

Awareness Programme



Collaborative Programme with RCFC NR-II

S. No.	Species	Photograph
1	<i>Artemisia maritima</i> Linn. Local Name: Noorie Family: Asteraceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2200–3500 m Traditional use: The dried herb is prepared as a decoction and consumed to eliminate intestinal parasitic worms. It remains a commonly used traditional remedy in the valley.	
2	<i>Artemisia absinthium</i> Linn. Local Name: Chhuma-Jom Family: Asteraceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000-3000 m Traditional use: The dried herb is powdered and administered in traditional medicine for the treatment of epilepsy and fever. The plant is also known for its aromatic and medicinal properties.	
3	<i>Angelica glauca</i> Edgew Local Name: Chora Family: Apiaceae) Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2500-3800 m Traditional use: Angelica glauca is an important medicinal herb of Gurez Valley. The local inhabitants prepare a decoction of the whole plant, which is traditionally used as a cardiac stimulant. It is also employed in indigenous medicine for the treatment of mental disorders and general weakness.	

37	<i>Orchis latifolia</i> Linn. Local Name: Nar-Mada Family: Orchidaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000-3800 m Traditional use: The powdered tuberous roots are mixed with milk and consumed as an aphrodisiac and restorative tonic.	
38	<i>Origanum vulgare</i> Linn. Local Name: Marzanjosh Family: Lamiaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 1800–3500 m Traditional use: A warm decoction of the herb is traditionally administered to treat menstrual suppression and related gynecological disorders.	
39	<i>Prunella vulgaris</i> Linn. Local Name: Kal-veoth Family: Lamiaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 1800–3500 m Traditional use: Fresh plant juice is applied externally for the treatment of piles. A decoction of the plant is also consumed to reduce fever and as an expectorant in respiratory ailments.	
40	<i>Pedicularis pectinata</i> Wall. Local Name: Khara Family: Scrophulariaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2500–4200 m Traditional use: The powdered herb is used as a diuretic and is believed to increase urine flow and support urinary health.	

33	<i>Malva verticillata</i> Linn. Local Name: Pudinakachh Family: Malvaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 1800–3000 m Traditional use: A decoction of the leaves is recommended during pregnancy and is believed to promote maternal health and well-being.	
34	<i>Mentha arvensis</i> Linn. Local Name: Pudinakachh Family: Lamiaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 1500–3500 m Traditional use: The dried leaves are boiled to prepare a decoction that is used as a carminative. It helps relieve indigestion, flatulence, and abdominal discomfort	
35	<i>Mentha longifolia</i> (L.) Huds. Local Name: Pudinakachh Family: Lamiaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 1500–3500 m Traditional use: Like <i>Mentha arvensis</i>, the dried leaves are used as a carminative and digestive aid. The aromatic herb is commonly consumed in herbal preparations.	
36	<i>Onosma hispidum</i> Wall. ex DC. Local Name: Rattanjot Family: Boraginaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000–4000 m Traditional use: The roots are used for the treatment of ulcers and urinary stone disorders. Traditional healers often combine the roots with <i>Bergenia</i> species and <i>Rubia cordifolia</i> for breaking kidney and bladder stones.	

4	<i>Arctium lappa</i> Linn. Local Name: Cheerkachh Family: Asteraceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000–3200 m Traditional use: The powdered roots of <i>Arctium lappa</i> are traditionally used as a diuretic. The species is valued for promoting urine flow and helping alleviate urinary complaints.	
5	<i>Atropa acuminata</i> Royle Local Name: Belladona Family: Solanaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000–3600 m Traditional use: The roots and leaves of <i>Atropa acuminata</i> are used as a sedative, analgesic, and diuretic. Due to its potent medicinal properties, it occupies an important place in local ethnomedicine.	
6	<i>Aconitum heterophyllum</i> Wall. ex Royle Local Name: Patees Family: Ranunculaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2500–4000 m Traditional use: It is one of the most important medicinal herbs of the Himalayas. The powdered roots are traditionally used in small doses for the treatment of diarrhoea, dysentery, fever, and enlargement of the spleen. Due to its high market value and excessive collection from the wild, the species has become rare in many parts of its natural range.	
7	<i>Angelica archangelica</i> var. <i>himalaica</i> Local Name: Chora Family: Apiaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2400–3800 m Traditional use: A decoction of the roots and fruits is used as an expectorant and is administered for respiratory ailments such as cough, cold, and chest congestion.	

8	<i>Arnebia benthamii</i> (Wall. ex G. Don) Johnston Local Name: Kahzaban Family: Boraginaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 3000-4500 m Traditional use: The roots yield a red dye and are used in traditional medicine for wound healing, skin diseases, burns, and inflammation.	
9	<i>Bergenia ciliata</i> Sternb. Local Name: Pahend/Korasadun Family: Saxifragaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000–3000 m Traditional use: The rhizome powder is used as a tonic and is especially renowned for treating kidney and bladder stones. It is among the most widely utilized medicinal plants of the Himalayan region.	
10	<i>Betula utilis</i> D. Don Local Name: Burz Family: Betulaceae Habit: Tree Altitudinal range (amsl): 2800–4000 m Traditional use: The bark infusion of Himalayan Birch is traditionally used as an antiseptic for treating infections and promoting wound healing.	
11	<i>Bunium persicum</i> (Boiss.) Fedtsch. Local Name: Kalazeera Family: Apiaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 1800–3500 m Traditional use: The seeds are highly valued for their medicinal and culinary importance. A decoction of the seeds is used to treat digestive disorders and enhance milk production in lactating mothers.	

29	<i>Juglans regia</i> Linn. Local Name: Dun Family: Juglandaceae Habit: Tree Altitudinal range (amsl): 1500–3300 m Traditional use: The bark and green fruit pericarp are used for strengthening gums, cleaning teeth, and maintaining oral hygiene.	
30	<i>Jurinea macrocephala</i> Benth. Local Name: Dhup Family: Asteraceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 3000-4500 m Traditional use: The roots of Jurinea macrocephala are used in traditional medicine for relieving colic pain. A decoction prepared from the roots is administered to alleviate abdominal discomfort and digestive disorders.	
31	<i>Lavatera kashmiriana</i> Camb. Local Name: Reshma Khatmi Family: Malvaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000–3500 m Traditional use: The roots are traditionally used for the treatment of rheumatic pain and inflammation. The species is valued by local communities for its analgesic properties.	
32	<i>Macrotomia benthamii</i> DC. Local Name: Jogpasha Family: Boraginaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2500-4000 m Traditional use: A decoction prepared from the roots is used as a febrifuge to reduce fever. It is also employed in the treatment of ulcers and related ailments.	

25	<i>Hippophae rhamnoides</i> Linn. Local name: Poppo Family: Elaeagnaceae Habit: Shrub Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000-4000 m Traditional use: Fruit jelly prepared from Sea Buckthorn is consumed for hepatic enlargement and general health improvement	
26	<i>Hyoscyamus niger</i> Linn. Local Name: Bazarbang Family: Solanaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000–3800 m Traditional use: The powdered herb is traditionally used to treat asthma, whooping cough, and respiratory discomfort.	
27	<i>Inula racemosa</i> Hook. f. Local Name: Poshkar Family: Asteraceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000-4000 m Traditional use: Root powder or decoction is widely used in the treatment of asthma, bronchitis, and other respiratory disorders.	
28	<i>Inula royleana</i> DC. Local Name: Punara/Poshkar Family: Asteraceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000–3500 m Traditional use: The root decoction serves as an expectorant, while the herb paste is applied externally to treat skin diseases.	

12	<i>Bupleurum falcatum</i> Linn. Family: Apiaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000–3500 m Traditional use: A decoction prepared from the whole plant is traditionally used in the treatment of liver disorders and digestive ailments.	
13	<i>Berberis lycium</i> Royle Local Name: Kawdach Family: Berberidaceae Habit: Shrub Altitudinal range (amsl): 1500–3000 m Traditional use: It is one of the most widely utilized medicinal shrubs in the western Himalaya.	
14	<i>Cichorium intybus</i> Linn. Local Name: Kasini Family: Asteraceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 1500–3000 m Traditional use: Powdered roots are used in traditional medicine to treat liver disorders, spleen enlargement, and menstrual complaints.	
15	<i>Codonopsis ovata</i> Benth. Family: Campanulaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2500–3800 m Traditional use: The root powder is applied externally on wounds and ulcers to facilitate healing and prevent infection.	

16	<i>Corydalis ramosa</i> Wall. Local Name: Ralkul Family: Papaveraceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2500-4000 m Traditional use: A cold extract of the herb is applied externally for the treatment of various eye diseases.	
17	<i>Cuscuta reflexa</i> Roxb. Local Name: Janeo-bal Family: Convolvulaceae Habit: Climber Altitudinal range (amsl): 1500-3000 m Traditional use: A cold aqueous extract of the plant is traditionally used for washing wounds and preventing infection.	
18	<i>Crataegus songarica</i> K. Koch Local Name: Ring Kul Family: Rosaceae Habit: Shrub Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000-3200 m Traditional use: The fruits are consumed fresh and are considered beneficial for cardiovascular health. Traditional communities also use the fruits for digestive ailments and general well-being.	
19	<i>Dactylorhiza hatagirea</i> (D. Don) Local Name: Salam Panja Family: Orchidaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2800-4200 m Traditional use: The tubers are regarded as a powerful tonic and aphrodisiac. They are traditionally used to improve strength, vitality, and reproductive health. Due to overharvesting, the species is considered threatened throughout the Himalayas.	

20	<i>Epipactis latifolia</i> All. Local Name: Ikchha-neuli Family: (Orchidaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000-3500 m Traditional use: A decoction of the whole plant is consumed for relief from heart pain and related ailments.	
21	<i>Euphorbia pilosa</i> Linn. Local Name: Burse Kachh Family: Euphorbiaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000-3500 m Traditional use: The whole plant extract is traditionally used for the treatment of fistular sores and skin infections.	
22	<i>Euphrasia officinalis</i> Linn. Local Name: Pushi-kachh Family: Scrophulariaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2000-4000 m Traditional use: A decoction prepared from the plant is taken to cure jaundice and improve liver function.	
23	<i>Fritillaria cirrhosa</i> Hook. f. Local Name: Sheetkar Family: Liliaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2800-4200 m Traditional use: The powdered herb is highly valued for treating tuberculosis, broncho-asthma, and chronic respiratory ailments.	
24	<i>Heracleum candicans</i> Wall. Local Name: Churu/Mirkul Family: Apiaceae Habit: Herb Altitudinal range (amsl): 2500-4000 m Traditional use: The powdered fruits are used as an aphrodisiac and general health tonic.	